

Impact of Health System Specialty Pharmacist-Liaison Teams on Patient Outcomes



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BACKGROUND

- The relationship between clinical pharmacists and pharmacy liaisons is paramount in enabling health system specialty pharmacy services to provide patients high-touch care.
- Trellis Rx, a technology-enabled specialty pharmacy services provider, has developed a system that empowers pharmacy liaisons to serve in a more active role in patient care.
- Pharmacy liaisons working onsite at health systems collect safety- and efficacy-related data using a standard questionnaire in Arbor®, Trellis Rx’s proprietary specialty pharmacy technology platform. This triggers protocol-driven interventions, which are reviewed and completed by the pharmacy liaison’s onsite pharmacist counterpart.
- Expanding the role of the pharmacy liaison provides the pharmacist with additional support which improves patient outcomes long-term.

OBJECTIVES

- The primary goal of this study was to quantify and assess the number and types of interventions triggered as a result of data collected by pharmacy liaisons using a standard questionnaire in Arbor during monthly patient touchpoints and then reviewed and completed by their pharmacist counterpart to improve patient outcomes.

METHODS

Design	This was a retrospective, multisite study from April 2019-March 2020 analyzing interventions triggered as a result of data collected by pharmacy liaisons using a standard questionnaire in Arbor.
Setting	Our high-touch care model involves initial counseling and education with the pharmacist, monthly touchpoints with the pharmacy liaison, and ongoing counseling and support from the pharmacist. During the monthly pharmacy liaison touchpoints, pharmacy liaisons collect safety- and efficacy-related data using a standard questionnaire in Arbor, triggering protocol-driven interventions for pharmacist follow-up and review.
Measures	Interventions triggered as a result of data collected during pharmacy liaison touchpoints and then completed by a clinical pharmacist. Intervention data was sorted into subtypes and assessed for outcomes.
Analysis	A total of 4,200 interventions triggered as a result of pharmacy liaison touchpoints were analyzed.

RESULTS

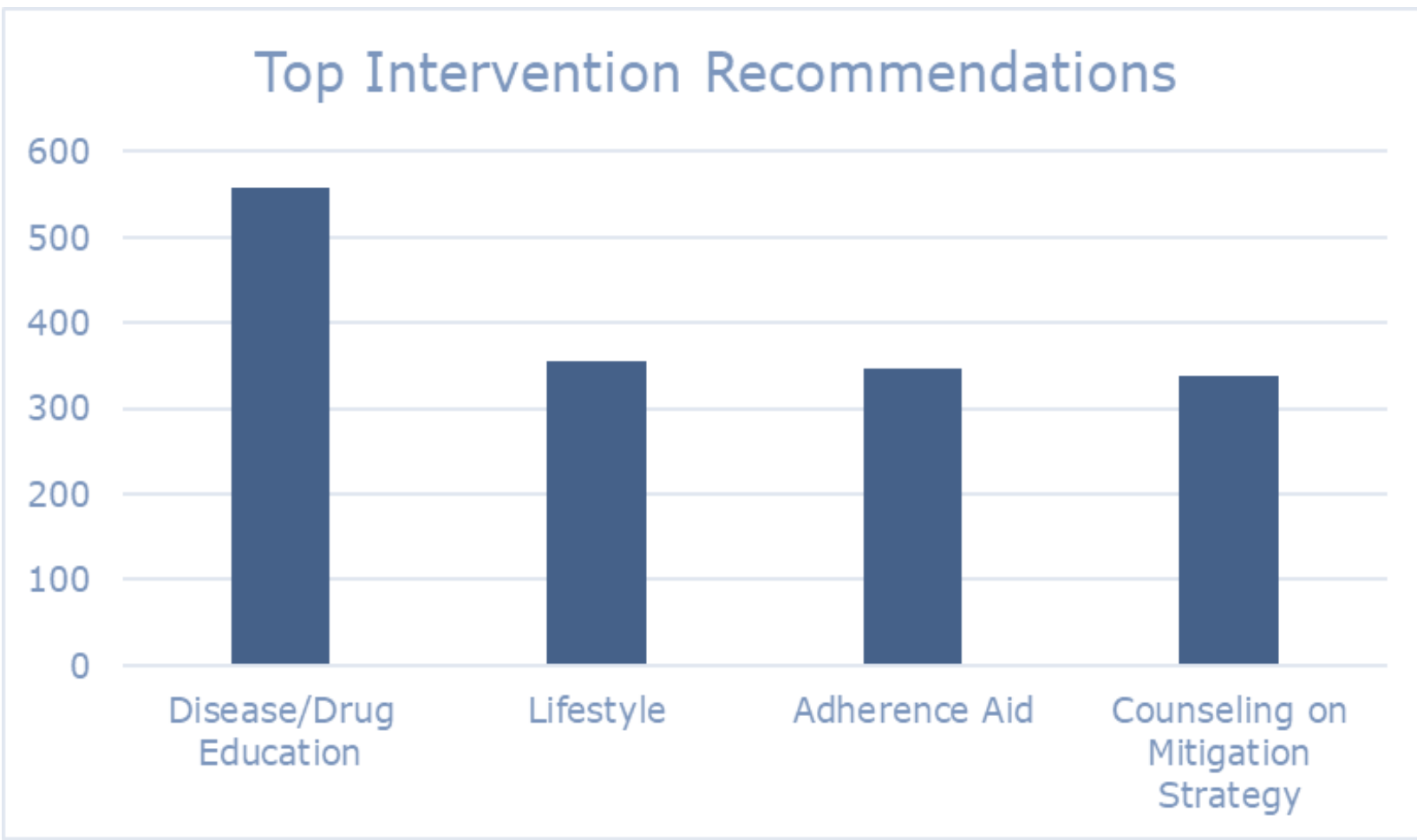
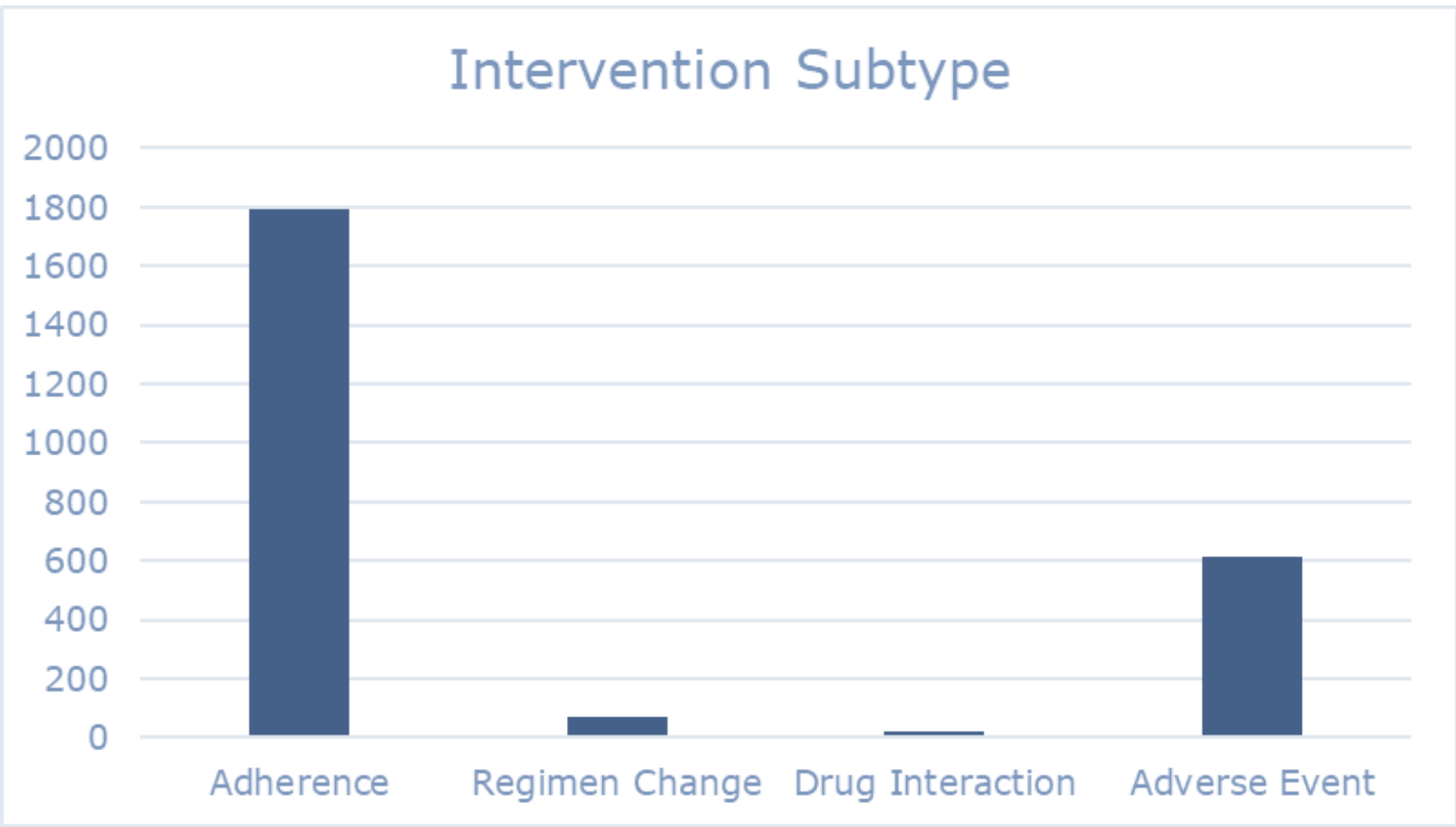
FIGURE 1:

Intervention Subtypes
Adherence
Regimen Change
Drug Interaction
Adverse Event
Lab Requirement
Referral of service or Linkage to Care Opportunity

Multiple intervention types were triggered as a result of data collected by pharmacy liaisons during patient touchpoints.

- 4,200 interventions were triggered based on data collected by pharmacy liaisons during patient touchpoints.
- These interventions, which were reviewed and completed by the pharmacy liaison’s pharmacist counterpart, resulted in therapy changes, dosing modifications, discontinuations, holding of therapy, additional patient education, lab orders, additional provider visits, and adherence aid recommendations.

FIGURE 2&3 :



CONCLUSIONS

Locally-Embedded Model

Based on the quantity and types of interventions triggered as a result of data collected by pharmacy liaisons, we found that having a model that embeds this pharmacist-pharmacy liaison relationship within health systems results in comprehensive, high touch patient care and an optimized workflow.

Liaison Engagement

Expanding the role of the pharmacy liaison provides the pharmacist with additional support to provide high-touch care which improves patient outcomes long-term.

Improved Outcomes

This model ensures continuous patient monitoring, ultimately resulting in faster identification and resolution of patient needs or medication-related issues for safe and effective medication use.

Liaison-patient touchpoints help drive clinical outcomes.

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